

QA Release Readiness Kit

Practical Templates for QA Managers

Version 1.0 - Master Guide

This guide explains how to use the kit as a release-control workflow: readiness, bug triage, risk ownership, regression scope, production deployment, rollback, reporting, and post-release learning.

Start here	Purpose
Open Command Center	Use the local dashboard to navigate the kit and track preparation status.
Use the Tracker Workbook	Manage release readiness, risks, bugs, regression, deployment, and post-release actions.
Run Go / No-Go	Make a release decision based on evidence, not pressure.

1. Product Overview

This kit is a practical operating system for software release quality. It is built for QA Managers, QA Leads, Release Managers, Product Managers, and teams that need a repeatable release-readiness process.

2. Recommended Workflow

Use the assets in order: scope, readiness, bugs, risks, regression, production, decision, deployment, and retrospective.

3. Core Templates

The core templates are designed to be copied into your team tools and adapted to your release cadence.

4. Command Center

The local HTML command center is an offline dashboard with links, browser-based status tracking, and an export option.

5. Tracker Workbook

The workbook provides a structured place to track readiness score, blocker bugs, high risks, regression status, deployment status, and action items.

6. AI Prompt Library

The AI prompts help convert messy release notes, Jira exports, test results, and risk comments into structured QA recommendations.

7. Publishing and Selling Notes

The kit is packaged as a digital product with a product description, launch post, FAQ, and first-buyer email.

Phase	Template	Output
Planning	Release Readiness Checklist	Release scope and readiness gaps
Testing	Regression Scope Matrix	Critical coverage status
Bug triage	Bug Triage Matrix	Fix, accept, defer, or investigate decisions
Risk management	Release Risk Register	Owned and mitigated risks
Decision	Go / No-Go Template	Go, Conditional Go, No-Go, or Partial Release
Deployment	Production Deployment Checklist	Deployment and rollback readiness
Post release	Retrospective and Escaped Defects Analysis	Lessons and next actions

Release Readiness Checklist

- Use it 1-2 days before release decision.
- Score each area from 0 to 3.
- Use the score as decision support, not as a replacement for judgment.

- Override the score when blockers, rollback gaps, or high unowned risks exist.

Go / No-Go Meeting

- Prepare status before the meeting.
- Use the meeting for decisions, not generic status updates.
- Document accepted risks and the decision owner.
- Use Conditional Go only when risk is understood and owned.

Bug Triage

- Every blocker/high bug needs severity, priority, owner, fix version, and release decision.
- A fixed bug is not release-ready until retested or explicitly accepted.
- Do not allow vague bug states to enter go/no-go.

Risk Register

- Every High/Critical risk needs an owner.
- Accepted risk needs explicit approver.
- A risk without mitigation is either accepted or treated as a blocker.

Regression Scope

- Focus on changed areas, critical flows, integrations, and high-risk data/API paths.
- Skipped tests require a reason.
- Automation failures require analysis before they are ignored.

Production Readiness

- Validate deployment steps, feature flags, tenant configuration, database migration, monitoring, alerts, rollback, and post-deployment sanity.

Post-Release Learning

- Analyze escaped defects without blame.
- Convert findings into automation, regression, Jira, monitoring, or process actions.

Decision	Use when	Required evidence
Go	No material blockers and readiness evidence is sufficient.	Passed critical checks, no blockers, production and rollback ready.
Conditional Go	Risk exists but is understood, owned, and accepted.	Risk acceptance, mitigation, owner, monitoring/rollback trigger.
No-Go	Release has blockers or unknown critical risk.	Blocker list, missing readiness evidence, decision owner.
Partial Release	Some scope is safe and risky scope can be excluded.	Reduced scope, removed items, updated regression and release notes.
Rollback-Prepared Go	Release can proceed only with active rollback readiness.	Rollback owner, rollback steps, monitoring trigger.

Command Center Details

Open `12_COMMAND_CENTER/Start_Command_Center.html`. It works locally in a browser and stores status only in local browser storage. It cannot directly edit local files because browsers restrict disk-write access for security. Use it as a navigation and control page.

Feature	Description
Template navigation	Direct links to the most important kit files.

Local status tracking	Mark each asset as Not Started, In Progress, Ready, Needs Review, or Done.
Progress health	Shows Green, Yellow, or Red based on local status selections.
Status export	Exports local status as JSON.
Workbook link	Quick link to the Excel tracker workbook.

Tracker Workbook Sheets

Sheet	Purpose
Dashboard	Release metadata, health metrics, next actions, and decision status.
Release_Readiness	Scored checklist with readiness percentage and recommendation.
Risk_Register	Release risks, probability, impact, risk level, owner, mitigation, decision, and status.
Bug_Triage	Bug impact, severity, priority, blocker flag, and release decision.
Regression_Scope	Regression flows, risk level, owner, execution status, and evidence.
Deployment	Deployment, monitoring, rollback, and post-deploy readiness.
Post_Release	Lessons learned and escaped-defect actions.
Lists	Dropdown values used across the workbook.

AI Prompt Usage Rules

- Remove customer-sensitive data, passwords, API keys, tokens, connection strings, and production secrets before using any AI tool.
- Ask AI to separate facts from assumptions.
- Require a recommended decision and missing-information list.
- Use AI output as analysis support, not as final approval.

Digital Product Packaging

Asset	Why it matters
PDF Guide	Professional printable overview for the buyer.
Markdown templates	Easy to copy into team tools.
Excel tracker	Operational release tracking.
HTML Command Center	Differentiates the product with a tech/control-room feel.
Marketing assets	Makes the product easier to publish and sell.

Version 1.0 Validation Checklist

- All required folders exist.
- Main template files exist and contain practical content.
- Command Center opens locally and uses relative links.
- Workbook has no obvious formula errors in key ranges.
- Master Guide renders cleanly to PDF and PNG pages.
- ZIP package opens correctly.